

Object Equality

29 January 2026 11:51 AM

Rules for Overriding equals()

When overriding equals(), you should adhere to the general contract specified in the Oracle documentation:

1. **Reflexive:** An object must be equal to itself (x.equals(x) must be true).
2. **Symmetric:** If x.equals(y) is true, then y.equals(x) must also be true.
3. **Transitive:** If x.equals(y) is true and y.equals(z) is true, then x.equals(z) must also be true.
4. **Consistent:** Multiple invocations of x.equals(y) must consistently return the same result, provided no information used in the comparisons is modified.
5. **Null comparison:** For any non-null reference value x, x.equals(null) must return false.

```
public class Feet {  
  
    private int value;  
  
    @Override  
    public boolean equals(Object o) {  
        if (o == null || getClass() != o.getClass()) return false;  
        Feet = (Feet) o;  
        return Objects.equals(value, feet.value);  
    }  
  
    @Override  
    public int hashCode() {  
        return Objects.hashCode(value);  
    }  
}
```